

Prefinality - Clear Before Finality

Teaching version. Full prefinality.py dump is in reference/.

Source: [gate/prefinality.py \(law\)](#) | [reference/06-...code-dump.pdf](#) | Undefined word? Open doc 18 (Layer 0 atoms) and define it before continuing.

TEACHING DOC. 10-page code dump quarantined in reference/. Undefined word? Open doc 18 (Layer 0 atoms) and define it before continuing.

Plain opener

Before money (or a similar final transfer) actually finishes, ask GO / NO_GO / HOLD. A green sticker is not enough. At the moment of effectuation, Clear means: the proof can be rebuilt as presented AND authority is still LIVE. If fields are missing, policy fails, fuse is DEAD, or receipt cannot be verified - NO_GO.

What Prefinality is

- Doctrine + machinery inside Gate/Nisaba - not a sister company
- Evaluates whether a transfer/finality step may proceed
- Binds a signed receipt to a fingerprint of the transfer
- Clearance remains distinct from execution (write_executed false here)

Decisions

- GO - may proceed only if receipt still verifies and is unexpired at commit
- HOLD - human review before commit
- NO_GO - do not sign or send; fail closed

Rails (adapters, same mouth idea)

- x402 - before an agent wallet signs
- rtp - before instant fiat credit / payment order

Fail-closed triggers (examples)

- Bad/missing amount or counterparty
- Amount over mandate cap
- Routing anomaly / injection into destination
- Fuse DEAD
- Signing required but unsigned in prod

What to hunt later in the code dump

- evaluate vs verify
- transfer_fingerprint
- mint/verify receipt JWT
- write_executed false / clearance_only true in responses

Retrieval drill

- Define Clear without saying Clear.
- Why is GO alone not enough at effectuation?
- Name three NO_GO reasons.